

**New
Uzbekistan
University**

School of Academic Excellence

Course Syllabus

**First Principles of New Uzbekistan University
HASS 100**

**Fall Semester
2025**

Course Syllabus

Course Title	First Principles of New Uzbekistan University		
Course Code	HASS 100		
Credits / ECTS	3 Credits / 6 ECTS	Total Hours	180
Contact hours per week	3 hours of lectures		
Pre-requisite(s)	None		
Semester	Fall	Academic Year	2025-2026
Course leader	Dr. Alfira Makhmutova		
Email	a.makhmutova@newuu.uz		
Office Number	UCA 208		

Office Hours	Monday 10:00 - 12:00 Tuesday 10:00 - 12:00
Textbook	1. OpenStax. (2024). <i>College success</i> (2nd ed.). OpenStax, Rice University. https://openstax.org/books/college-success/pages/index 2. Cottrell, S. (2019). <i>The study skills handbook</i> (5th ed.). Red Globe Press.
Reference Books	Academic Books 1. Seli, H. (2019). <i>Motivation and learning strategies for college success: A focus on self-regulated learning</i> (6th ed.). Routledge. https://doi.org/10.4324/9780429400711 2. Northouse, P. G. (2016). <i>Leadership: Theory and practice</i> (7th ed.). SAGE Publications. 3. de Silva, D., & Freund, C. (1987). <i>Success strategies for college students</i>. Wichita State University. 4. Coursera course by the University of Washington, U101: Understanding College and College Life (8 modules) https://www.coursera.org/learn/college-life Legal and Policy Documents 1. Law of the Republic of Uzbekistan "On Education." (2020). <i>Republic of Uzbekistan</i>. (Unofficial English translation). https://cis-legislation.com/document.fwx?rgn=127569 2. UNESCO. (1997). <i>Right to education: Uzbekistan—Law on Education (extracts)</i>. United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization. https://files.eric.ed.gov/fulltext/ED613922.pdf 3. Cabinet of Ministers of the Republic of Uzbekistan (2017): Decree #610, Improving of foreign languages learning skills. https://lex.uz/docs/-3304915 (Accessed 20.11.2020) 4. Ministry of Public Education of Uzbekistan (2019): Memorandum in the field of human capital development. https://www.uzedu.uz/en/budet-provedena-ocenka-urovna-znanijvseh-ucit-elej-anglijskogo-azyka-pri-podderzke-ef-language-learning-solutions (Accessed 13.12.2020). 5. National Database of Legislation of the Republic of Uzbekistan (2012): Decree #1875, The Decision on Measures to Further Improve the

System of Learning Foreign Languages. <https://www.lex.uz/docs/2126032> (Accessed 10.12.2020).

6. Presidential Decree of the Republic of Uzbekistan No. UP-158 "On the Strategy 'Uzbekistan – 2030'", dated September 11, 2023. Lex.uz. <https://lex.uz/docs/6600404>

Books and Academic Studies

1. Qahhor, A. (1937). *Adabiyot muallimi* [The literature teacher]. Uzbekistan: [Publisher unknown].
2. Shaturaev, J. N. (2022). *Public education of Indonesia and Uzbekistan: Quality of education & academic outcomes*. LAP Lambert Academic Publishing. <https://doi.org/10.13140/RG.2.2.31446.60482>
3. Sharimova, A., & colleagues (Eds.). (2024). *The political economy of education in Central Asia*. Springer. <https://doi.org/10.1007/978-981-99-8517-3>

Motivational & Success-Oriented Books

1. Covey, S. R. (2020). *The 7 habits of highly effective people: Powerful lessons in personal change* (30th anniversary ed.). Simon & Schuster.
2. Duhigg, C. (2014). *The power of habit: Why we do what we do in life and business*. Random House.
3. Dweck, C. S. (2006). *Mindset: The new psychology of success*. Random House.
4. Grant, A. (2023). *Hidden potential: The science of achieving greater things*. Viking.
5. Sinek, S. (2011). *Start with why: How great leaders inspire everyone to take action*. Portfolio/Penguin.
6. Clear, J. (2018). *Atomic habits: An easy & proven way to build good habits & break bad ones*. Avery.

Course Description:

This course equips first-year students with the knowledge, skills, and attitudes necessary for success in higher education at New Uzbekistan University (NEWUU). It introduces students to the role and purpose of higher education, university governance, and academic policies, while fostering information literacy, academic integrity, and ethical reasoning. Through weekly themes, students will practice time management, effective study strategies, reading and note-taking, as well as develop critical, analytical, and creative thinking skills. The course also emphasizes digital literacy and responsible engagement with emerging technologies such as AI, alongside communication, teamwork, and intercultural competence. By exploring NEWUU's academic programs and career pathways, students will be encouraged to connect their studies with long-term personal and professional goals. Ultimately, the course integrates foundational knowledge of institutional expectations with transferable skills in problem-solving, innovation, and communication, preparing students for responsible, resilient, and successful participation in academic and societal life.

Course Instructors:

Position	Name	Email	Office	Office hours
Professor	Alfira Makhmutova	a.makhmutova@newuu.uz	208	Monday 10:00 - 12:00 Tuesday 10:00 -12:00

Course Learning Outcomes (CLOs):

By the end of successful completion of this course, the student will be able to:

No.	Description
CLO1	Understanding the academic policies and procedures of NEWUU
CLO2	Understanding the basics of Information Literacy
CLO3	Understanding fundamental concepts of Academic Integrity
CLO4	Critical Thinking and Problem-Solving

No.	Description
	• Apply first principles to deconstruct complex problems into simpler, more manageable parts • Formulate logical arguments and solutions based on fundamental concepts rather than relying on assumptions or existing methods.
CLO5	Innovation and Creativity • Encourage creative thinking by exploring how first principles can be applied in novel ways to generate innovative solutions. • Challenge conventional thinking by questioning assumptions and exploring alternative approaches based on first principles.
CLO6	Understand the programs at NEWUU and career paths • Analyze the relationship between first principles in one discipline and their application in another, fostering an interdisciplinary approach. • Recognize patterns and similarities in the foundational concepts across various fields of study.
CLO7	Effective Communication • Communicate complex ideas clearly and effectively, demonstrating a deep understanding of first principles. • Collaborate with peers to discuss and refine ideas, using first principles as a common framework for discussion.
CLO8	Ethical Reasoning Evaluate ethical implications of decisions and actions through the lens of first principles. • Develop a personal ethical framework based on foundational concepts, enabling responsible decision-making in personal and professional contexts.

Alignment of Course Learning Outcomes (CLOs) to Student/Program Outcomes of Programs

CLO	1. Chemical & Materials Engineering 2. Mechanical Engineering 3. Software Engineering 4. Artificial Intelligence & Robotics 5. Cybersecurity 6. Industrial Management	7. Economics & Data Science	8. Pedagogy	9. Applied Mathematics
CLO1	SO7		SO6	SO1
CLO2	SO7	SO7	SO7	SO2
CLO3	SO4	SO5	SO4	SO4
CLO4	SO1, SO2	SO1, SO2	SO1	SO1
CLO5	SO2	-	SO5	SO1
CLO6	SO7	-	SO6	SO5
CLO7	SO3	SO6	SO3	SO3
CLO8	SO4	SO5	SO4	SO4

Contribution level of Course Learning Outcomes(CLOs) to Student/Program Outcomes

	SO1	SO2	SO3	SO4	SO5	SO6	SO7	SO8
Chemical & Materials Engineering - ALL CLOs	High	High	--	--	--	Medium	Medium	N/A
Mechanical Engineering - ALL CLOs	High	High	--	--	--	Medium	Medium	N/A
Software Engineering - ALL CLOs	High	High	--	--	--	Medium	Medium	N/A
Artificial Intelligence & Robotics - ALL CLOs	High	High	--	--	--	Medium	Medium	N/A
Cybersecurity - ALL CLOs	High	High	--	--	--	Medium	Medium	N/A

	SO1	SO2	SO3	SO4	SO5	SO6	SO7	SO8
Industrial Management - ALL CLOs	High	High	--	--	--	Medium	Medium	N/A
Economics & Data Science - ALL CLOs	High	High	--	--	--	Medium	Medium	--
Pedagogy - ALL CLOs	High	--	High	--	High	Medium	--	Medium
Applied Mathematics - ALL CLOs	High	High	--	--	--	N/A	N/A	N/A

Weekly Distribution of Course Topics/Contents

Week	Class type	Topic	Required Materials	Course Learning Outcome
1	Lecture	• Introduction to University Life & Purpose of Higher Education	CS: Ch.1.1–1.4; Cottrell: Intro, Ch.1	CLO1, CLO6
		• Guest speaker (TBC)		
2	Lecture	• The Truth About Learning Styles	CS: Ch.2.1–2.7; Cottrell: Ch.4, Ch.5	CLO4
		• Guest speaker (TBC)		
3	Lecture	• Understanding University Policies	Student Handbook and other academic policy documents	CLO1, CLO3
		• Guest speaker (TBC)		
4	Lecture	• Managing Your Time and Priorities	CS: Ch.3.1–3.7; Cottrell: Ch.6, Ch.7	CLO4, CLO6
		• Guest speaker (TBC)		
5	Lecture	• Planning Your Academic Pathways	CS: Ch.4.1–4.4; Cottrell: Ch.3	CLO4, CLO6
		• Guest speaker (TBC)		
6	Lecture	• Reading and Note-Taking	CS: Ch.5.1–5.3; Cottrell: Ch.10	CLO2, CLO7
		• Guest speaker (TBC)		
7	Lecture	• Studying, Memory, and Test Taking	CS: Ch.6.1–6.3; Cottrell: Ch.17, Ch.18	CLO2, CO4
		• Guest speaker (TBC)		

Topic	Required Materials	Course Learning Outcome
Midterm Exam Week		CLO1-CLO7
- Thinking - Guest speaker (TBC)	CS: Ch.7.1–7.7; Cottrell: Ch.12, Ch.11	CLO4, CLO5
- Communication - Guest speaker (TBC)	CS: Ch.8.1–8.5; Cottrell: Ch.8, Ch.14	CLO4, CLO7
- Digital Literacy & AI in Education - Guest speaker (TBC)	CS: Ch.7.7; Cottrell: Ch.11 (digital), Ch.12	CLO2, CLO3
- Developing cultural competence: Learning in diverse and international contexts - Guest speaker (TBC)	CS: Ch.9.1–9.4; Cottrell: Ch.9	CLO6, CLO8
- Engaging in a Healthy Lifestyle - Guest speaker (TBC)	CS: Ch.11.1–11.6; Cottrell: Ch.7	CLO6, CLO8
- Planning for Your Future - Guest speaker (TBC)	CS: Ch.12.1–12.3; Cottrell: Ch.3, Ch.16	CLO6, CLO5
- Higher Education & Society - Guest speaker (TBC)	Law of the Republic of Uzbekistan "On Education." (2020).	CLO1, CLO8

Distribution of Course Assignments/Quizzes

Assignments	Course Learning Outcome
- Quiz 1	CLO1, CLO6
- Quiz 2	CLO1, CLO2
- Quiz 3	CLO1, CLO3
- Quiz 4	CLO4
- Quiz 5	CLO5
- Quiz 6	CLO6
- Quiz 7	CLO7

Week	Assignments	Course Learning Outcome
8	Midterm Exam Week	
9	- Quiz 8	CLO4, CLO5
10	- Quiz 9	CLO6, CLO8
11	- Quiz 10	CLO7, CLO3
12	- Quiz 11	CLO2, CLO4
13	- Quiz 12	CLO6, CLO8
14	- Quiz 13	CLO5, CLO7
15	Revision	
16	Final Exam Week	CLO1-CLO8

Students' Assessment:

Students are assessed as follows:

Component	Description	Weight
Weekly Quizzes	13 Google Form quizzes based on weekly topics. Opens Friday and closes Sunday at 23:59. Auto-graded (MCQs).	Achieve at least 40% overall average across all quizzes.
Attendance	Total: 15 weeks × 3 hours/week = 45 hours . Attendance is tracked via QR check-in.	Do not miss more than 25% of total class hours (max 11 hours , about 4 full weeks).
Pass Criteria	Must meet both requirements above (quizzes and attendance).	Pass: Meets both. Fail: Misses either requirement.
Total		100%

Students' Workload:

Students' workload is distributed as follows:

Activity	Hrs.	%	Assessment methods and criteria
In-Class Time	42	23%	Attendance (recorded weekly in system)
Independent Study	56	31%	Reflected in quiz performance
Online Quizzes (weekly, outside class)	28	16%	13 Weeks average = final grade
Assignments / Reflections (optional, very light)	0-10	0-5%	If used: short tasks uploaded to HERO
Group Discussions	12	7%	Informal, supports engagement but not graded
Individual Development	12	7%	Self-directed, not graded
Examinations	0	0%	-
Workshops / Fieldwork	0	0%	-
Total	180	100%	

Course Policies and Expectations

1. Attendance Policy

Attendance is mandatory and serves as the main requirement for passing this course. Students may not miss more than 25% of the total instructed hours. According to the Academic Policy and Procedures, exceeding this limit will result in automatic withdrawal from the course with a failing result. Attendance will be recorded through the university's official attendance system at every class meeting. Punctuality is also required, students arriving more than 10 minutes late will be marked absent for the entire session.

2. Academic Integrity

Maintaining academic integrity is a fundamental expectation at New Uzbekistan University. Plagiarism, cheating, and any other forms of academic misconduct are strictly prohibited and will result in significant consequences, such as failing grades or potential dismissal. Students are required to attend in person and honestly record their own attendance, without misrepresentation. Respectful conduct toward instructors, guest speakers, and peers is essential, including listening attentively and avoiding disruptions. When using suggested readings, digital tools, or AI platforms, students should engage responsibly and avoid unacknowledged copying if short reflective tasks are assigned. Since there are no major exams or written assessments, integrity in this course focuses on honesty, responsibility, respect for others, and professional behavior in all classroom interactions.

3. Submission Deadlines

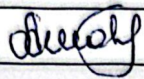
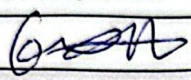
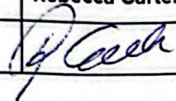
Quizzes will be assigned weekly and must be completed within the timeframe announced by the instructor. Since this course relies on continuous assessment, late quiz submissions will not be accepted unless there are exceptional circumstances with prior approval and proper documentation. Students are responsible for checking their university email regularly for quiz links and deadlines. Staying organized and completing quizzes on time is essential to successfully passing the course.

4. Student Conduct

Professional and respectful behavior is expected in all academic settings. Disruptive actions, such as the use of mobile phones, unrelated activities, or leaving the class without permission, are not permitted. Such behavior may result in disciplinary actions. Respect for the learning environment ensures a productive and inclusive atmosphere for all students.

5. Communication

All official university communications will be conducted through your university email. It is your responsibility to regularly check your email for important updates, announcements, and notifications. Timely communication is vital to staying informed and ensuring smooth coordination with instructors and the academic office.

Approval			
Course leader			
Name	Dr. Alfira Makhmutova		
Signature		Date:	3/09/2025
Department Head			
Name	Dr. Gonçalo Pinto		
Signature		Date	3/9/2025
Head of Quality Assurance & Accreditation Department			
Name	Rebecca Carter		
Signature		Date	4.09.2025